Revised and Final Explanation

Part 1: Pakistan's Inception and Initial Challenges (1947 onwards)

1.1 The Interim Constitution and Early Governance

- After its establishment in 1947, Pakistan's government began functioning under a modified version of the **Government of India Act of 1935**, which served as the interim constitution until 1956[1].
- The country's first **Constituent Assembly** had two main functions[2]:
    - To act as the central legislature[3].
    - To frame a new constitution for the country[4].
- The two major parties in the First Constituent Assembly were the **Muslim League, which held 60 seats**, and the **Congress, which held 11**[5].
- Although Pakistan's political system was formally parliamentary and federal, in reality, it operated as a **unitary system** with a powerful executive branch that was supported by the army and bureaucracy[6].

1.2 Severe Initial Problems

- Framing a constitution was the single biggest challenge for the new nation[7].
- Pakistan faced numerous "colossal" difficulties from its very beginning[8]:
    - **Administrative Crisis:** The country started with an inadequate administrative system[9].
    - **Refugee Problem:** Approximately **seven million refugees** poured in from India, creating an extreme resettlement crisis that strained the "skeleton administration" to its breaking point[10101010].
    - **Resource Scarcity:** There was a severe lack of financial resources, communication, and transportation infrastructure[11].
    - **Territorial Issues:** The partitioning of Punjab and Bengal led Jinnah to lament that he had received a "truncated and mouth-eaten Pakistan"[12]. The **Radcliffe Award**, which determined the Punjab boundary, was particularly fatal as it gave India overland access to the Muslim-majority state of Jammu and Kashmir[13].
    - **Hostility from India:** The Indian Congress leadership was openly hostile, believing Pakistan would soon collapse[14]. To hasten this, the Indian government withheld Pakistan's share of cash balances and military assets[15].

1.3 The Powerful Civil-Military Bureaucracy

- The parliamentary system in Pakistan was built on a strong, pre-existing bureaucratic foundation[16].
- The civil services were well-established institutions that were unaccustomed to parliamentary authority and worked almost independently[17].
- The military supported the civil bureaucracy, creating a powerful **civil-military bloc**[18]. There was a clear danger that if politicians failed to establish their authority, this bloc would take over political functions[19].

Part 2: Political Leadership and Growing Instability

2.1 The Jinnah Era (1947–1948)

- Pakistan's first government was established with **Quaid-e-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah** as the first Governor-General and **Liaquat Ali Khan** as the first Prime Minister[20].
- The first cabinet included stalwarts like **Abdul Rab Nishtar** (Communications), **Fazal Rehman** (Interior), I.I. Chundrigar(Commerce), **Ghazanfar Ali Khan** (Agriculture), and **Ghulam Muhammad** (Finance)[21]. Other important appointments included **Sir Muhammad Zafarullah** as Pakistan's representative to the UN and **Sir Feroz Khan Noon** as an envoy to the Middle East[22].
- Jinnah's position as Governor-General was unique and far more powerful than a ceremonial head of state. As the "father of the nation," he held a **triple capacity**[23]:
    - Governor-General of Pakistan[24].
    - President of the Muslim League[25].
    - President of the Constituent Assembly[26].
- His decisions were considered obligatory, and the cabinet rarely functioned without his directives[27].

2.2 The Liaquat Ali Khan Era (1948–1951)

- After Jinnah's death in 1948, **Khawaja Nazimuddin** became the Governor-General[28].
- Prime Minister Liaquat Ali Khan worked to increase the authority of his office and establish parliamentary conventions[29].
- However, he **failed to achieve a consensus on a constitution**, which led to growing political opposition from the provinces[30].

2.3 The Rise of the Governor-General (1951–1954)

- After the assassination of Liaquat Ali Khan in 1951, **Khawaja Nazimuddin** stepped down as Governor-General to become the Prime Minister[31313131].
- **Ghulam Mohammad**, a former finance minister, became the new Governor-General[32].
- **Dismissal of Nazimuddin's Government (1953):** Prime Minister Nazimuddin was seen as a weak leader, especially after his failure to effectively handle the **1952 language riots in East Pakistan** and the **1953 Ahmadiya riots in Punjab**[33]. Citing these failures, Governor-General Ghulam Mohammad **dismissed Nazimuddin's cabinet**, even though Nazimuddin commanded a majority in the legislature[34]. This act marked a crucial turning point, establishing the Governor-General as the most powerful figure in the country[35].
- Ghulam Mohammad then appointed **Mohammad Ali Bogra**, Pakistan's Ambassador to the US, as the new Prime Minister—a personal choice that highlighted the weakness of the ruling Muslim League party[36363636].

2.4 The Dissolution of the First Constituent Assembly (1954)

- The Muslim League's massive defeat in the March 1954 East Pakistan elections further weakened its authority[37].
- In September 1954, the Constituent Assembly tried to curb the Governor-General's power by passing legislation that required him to act only on the advice of the cabinet[38].
- In retaliation, Governor-General Ghulam Mohammad **dissolved the Constituent Assembly** in October 1954, declaring a state of emergency[39].
- **The Maulvi Tamizuddin Khan Case:** The assembly's speaker, Maulvi Tamizuddin Khan, challenged the dissolution in the Sind Chief Court and won[40]. However, the **Federal Court of Pakistan overturned this decision**, upholding the Governor-General's action[41].

Part 3: The Second Constituent Assembly and the 1958 Coup

3.1 The Second Constituent Assembly (1955)

- The Federal Court ordered the formation of a Second Constituent Assembly, whose members were elected indirectly by provincial legislatures[42].
- This assembly was highly fragmented, composed of roughly 12 different political groups[43]. The assembly was dominated by landlords from West Pakistan and lawyers from East Pakistan[44].

3.2 Persistent Political Instability (1955–1958)

- **Iskander Mirza** succeeded Ghulam Mohammad as Governor-General in 1955[45]. A coalition government led by Prime Minister Chaudhri Mohammad Ali finally passed the

1956 Constitution, and Iskander Mirza became Pakistan's first President[464646].

- This period was marked by "a high degree of political instability"[47]. In just two years, Pakistan had **four different prime ministers**[48].
- Party loyalties constantly shifted[49]. President Mirza himself contributed to this instability by encouraging a dissident group to break away from the Muslim League and form the **Republican Party** in 1956[50].

3.3 The 1958 Martial Law

- The years leading up to 1958 were characterized by "instability, chaos and disorder"[51].
- In October 1958, President Iskander Mirza declared **martial law** and appointed the army chief, **General Muhammad Ayub Khan**, as the Chief Martial Law Administrator[52].
- Just three days later, General Ayub Khan forced Mirza to resign and assumed full control of the state and government himself[53].
- **Conclusion:** The document concludes that the failure to frame a constitution early, combined with numerous other problems, led to these major political setbacks and chronic instability[54].